

Last hurrah: Toni Kroos, competing in his final game before the Madridistas, joined Luka Modric, Nacho, Carvajal, and former player Paco Gento as the only players in history to win six European titles. AFP



hero in substitute Joselu, who scored twice in three minutes to stage a comeback against Bayern Munich. Bayern had been leading the tie until the 87th minute when Alphonso Davies smashed the ball past Lunin earlier in the second leg.

Emergence of a new era

While Marco Reus' (right) last dance did not have a fairytale ending, Edin Terzic's side will be proud of the way it approached the final, as actual contenders rather than underdogs.

Despite a disappointing domestic season, Dortmund pressured Real

Madrid for most of the final, much like it did to teams throughout the tournament.

However, in the end, it succumbed to Madrid's extraordinary narrative, just as many other sides have in the past.

With the revamped Champions League featuring 36 teams starting next season in an attempt to produce more 'competitive matches', football fans will eagerly await to see if it increases the disparity between European heavyweights and lower-ranked teams. They will also be keen to find out if it brings more jeopardy in qualification to the knockouts.



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